

LG releases Optimus 2X and Black

LG has released the Tegra 2 dual-core powered Optimus 2X for ₹30,000, and the super-slim Optimus Black for ₹27,000. For more details, go to <http://bit.ly/fvDix9>

Apple iPad 2 available in India

The price of an Apple iPad 2 via e-commerce in India varies between ₹34,900 for the Wi-Fi only 16GB tablet, up to ₹64,901 for the Wi-Fi + 3G 64GB version

Samsung introduces Galaxy Tab 10.1, 8.9; Galaxy S II gets 1.2GHz; bada 2 coming to India first

Samsung showcased the Galaxy Tab 10.1 and 8.9 Android Honeycomb tablets at its Samsung Unpacked event, surprising everyone with a brand new super slim design. At just 8.49 mm in thickness, which is lesser than the 8.8 mm Apple iPad 2. Both the Galaxy Tab 10.1 and 8.9 are nearly identical in terms of looks, differing only in screen size – though they have the same impressive WXGA 1280x800 resolution.

The two Honeycomb tablets are competitively priced with the 16GB Wi-Fi-only 10.1-inch model priced at \$499 and the 32GB model at \$599, while the 16GB Wi-Fi-only 8.9-inch model will retail for \$469, and the 32GB model for \$569. For now, only Wi-Fi models of the two tablets have been announced, though 3G and 4G HSPA+ tablets were detailed. While Samsung has still

not revealed the exact nature of the 1GHz dual-core application processor that powers both tablets, it is still assumed to be NVIDIA's Tegra 2 offering, instead of Exynos processor. The large 6000 mAh and 6860 mAh batteries are expected to give about 10 hours of video playback. Both tablets also pack Wi-Fi a/b/g/n connectivity, will support Flash 10.2, and have dual speakers for stereo surround sound.

Samsung has also announced a speed bump for its flagship Android phone, the Samsung Galaxy S II, which now goes from a 1 GHz dual-core Exynos processor to a 1.2 GHz dual-core processor, presumably with a BIOS update instead of an actual chip upgrade.

Also to be noted, is that the Samsung Google Nexus S (with Super LCD screen) has been officially launched in India, at

₹30,400 (MRP). Online retailers such as Flipkart have been quoting a much lower pre-order price of ₹27,999 for a while now, so expect prices to significantly lower than the MRP, especially as the prices of the original Galaxy S are still falling.

Samsung India has also announced that the bada 2.0 operating system will

arrive in India before anywhere else in the world, in July. It will bring a new UI, SDK support for Linux and Mac, third party SNS integration, HTML5 support, WAC compatibility, and Flash Lite. Features like operator billing support are also expected. ■



HTC Sensation features 1.2 GHz dual-core CPU, Sense 3.0 UI

HTC has confirmed that the rumoured super-phone, the HTC Pyramid, will be releasing in May or June, and will be called the HTC Sensation. The name is especially appropriate, as the device is the first to sport HTC's latest custom UI, HTC Sense 3.0.

The HTC Sensation will be one of the most powerful phones in the market when finally hits the shelves, with a 1.2 GHz dual-core CPU and Adreno 220 GPU onboard, part of Qualcomm's latest Snapdragon MSM8260 chipset. It sports 768MB of RAM. Its 8MP rear camera supports 1080p HD video recording at 30 frames per second, and, it has a 4.3-inch SuperLCD display with a 480x800 pixel resolution. Its

1,520 mAh battery is rated to deliver up to 400 hours of standby time, and up to 6.5 hours of talktime.

The most obvious comparison to be made is between this and the Samsung Galaxy S II, which the company introduced at MWC 2011. Both are Android Gingerbread devices that feature 1.2 GHz dual-core processors, and 4.3-inch displays. Unfortunately for HTC, on paper, the Galaxy S

II outshines the HTC Sensation, with more memory, onboard storage, a higher-resolution screen, better front-facing camera, dual-LED flash instead of single, document editing abilities, and USB on-the-go. ■



Windows Phone 7 NoDo update arrives; Mango detailed

Microsoft has released its first Windows Phone 7 update, codenamed NoDo, which brings the much vaunted Copy and Paste functionality to the platform, as well as other performance and interface enhancements, including better application and game performance and reduced load/resume times, improved Windows Marketplace search functions, and enhanced Wi-Fi connectivity and configuration options.

Other improvements include some Outlook interface and compatibility enhancements, better Facebook synchronisation, improved MMS reception and display, and, another much wanted feature – stability while switching between video and still camera modes.

The MIX 11 conference was the venue for Microsoft detailing the Mango update, which will bring features such as true multitasking, built-in hardware acceleration for Flash and video content and more complete Xbox integration, including a possible controller interface. ■

